

PAKISTAN

Pakistan: Key Country Details

Detail	Information
Official Name	Islamic Republic of Pakistan
Capital	Islamabad
Region (UN)	Asia-Pacific Group
Government Type	Federal parliamentary republic
President	Arif Alvi (as of 2025)
Prime Minister	Anwaar-ul-Haq Kakar (Caretaker as of 2025)
Currency	Pakistani Rupee (PKR)
UN Member Since	30 September 1947
Permanent UNSC Member	No
Key Issues	Security and terrorism, refugee management, gender inequality, development challenges

Book Recommendations

Book Title	Author	Why It's Useful
Pakistan: A Hard Country	Anatol Lieven	Deep political and social analysis
Pakistan: Between Mosque and Military	Hussain Haqqani	Insight on civil-military relations
The Struggle for Pakistan	Ayesha Jalal	Historical context and nation-building
Pakistan in the 21st Century	Farzana Shaikh	Modern challenges and policy
Military Inc.: Inside Pakistan's Military Economy	Ayesha Siddiqa	Understanding security and economics

Research Table: Pakistan & UNHRC

Source Name	Link	Why It's Useful
OHCHR – Pakistan Country Profile	OHCHR Pakistan	Official overview of treaty ratification and OHCHR activities, essential for understanding UN oversight. (ohchr.org)
UPR Submission (2022)	Pakistan UPR Submission PDF	Government self-review documenting progress and challenges across core rights areas.
UPR India Stakeholder Info (Cycle 4)	Stakeholder Summaries	Collection of NGO/UN submissions for the 4th UPR cycle—key for civil society context.
Amnesty International – Pakistan Page	Amnesty Pakistan	Ongoing documentation on extrajudicial killings, blasphemy, and FGM—vital NGO perspective.
UPR Outcome Video – Jan 2023	Pakistan UPR Adoption	Live recording of UNHRC interactive dialogue—shows how Pakistan responds in real time.
UPR Overview Portal	Pakistan UPR Index	Central hub for all UPR documents: state, stakeholder, outcome reports.
US State Dept 2023 Report (Online)	2023 Pakistan HR Report	Covers civil, political, labor, and refugee issues—provides broad rights context.
HRW World Report 2024 – Pakistan	HRW Pakistan 2024	Documents policing of Afghan refugees and minority rights—relevant refugee/labor themes.
UN Treaty Database – Pakistan	Pakistan Treaty Status	Shows which treaties Pakistan has ratified—fundamental for legal agenda.
HRW UPR Submission (2017)	2017 HRW Submission	Addresses counterterrorism abuses, blasphemy laws, disappearances—core UNHRC topics.
Amnesty Press (Oct 2024)	UNHR Committee Review	Alerts about ICCPR review—captures UNHRC treaty body oversight.
NCHR Mid-Term UPR Report 2023 (PDF)	NCHR UPR Analysis	Independent evaluation of UPR implementation—key for monitoring follow-up.

US State Dept 2022 PDF	Pakistan 2022 HR Report PDF	Detailed data on torture, custodial killings, freedom of press.
Human Rights Watch Migrant Focus	HRW Migrants & Refugees	Covers Afghan refugee crisis and detention—supports refugee/labor rights coverage.
UDoc – Pakistan Specific HR Report	MOHR UPR Report	Government-issued UPR paper detailing constitutional frameworks—direct state perspective.
UPR Info Pakistan Hub	UPR Info Page	External UN platform with full UPR process documents.
DOJ Immigration Review	DOJ Pakistan Country Info	US government outline of citizenship, religion, disability issues—helps refugee/detention theme.
UN Digest of Stakeholder Submissions	Summary Stakeholders	Consolidated NGO input for UPR—a valuable multi-stakeholder source.
State Dept UPR Overview	UPR Process	Explains the UN UPR mechanism—contextual for user education.
DFAT Pakistan Info (PDF)	Australia DFAT Report	External country analysis documenting Baloch, press, and security issues.
EveryCRS Human Rights Review	Pakistan CRS Report	Contains US Congressional analysis referring to ICCPR and security forces oversight.
Amnesty Digital Rights Investigation	Pakistan Spyware Campaign	Exposes digital repression of activists, central to online rights theme.
HRCP State of Rights 2024 (PDF)	HRCP 2024 Report	Local commission's annual review—a national benchmark for UNHRC comparison.
ICJ UPR Spotlight (Feb 2023)	ICJ UPR Analysis	Highlights systemic abuses in Pakistan flagged during UPR—NGO monitoring.
Al Jazeera – Dissent Crackdown	HRW on Dissent	Reports on crackdown on journalists—reviewed in UNHRC item 6 debates.
AP News – Afghan Refugee Expulsion	AP: Pressure on Afghans	Documents forced returns—critical for refugee protection assessments.
AP News – Blasphemy Shooting	AP: Blasphemy Suspect Killing	Highlights extrajudicial killings under blasphemy law—UNHRC due process focus.

AP News – Election Integrity Warning	<u>AP: Election Concerns</u>	Raises concerns over fairness in elections—important for political rights theme.
HRW Land-Grabs Minority Abuse	<u>HRW Blasphemy & Land</u>	Ties minority persecution to land seizures—bridges discrimination and property rights.
UPR Death Penalty Study (PDF)	<u>Death Penalty UPR Case</u>	Analyzes how Pakistan addresses death penalty through UPR—a key legal reform piece.

Ten Unique Aspects: Pakistan & UNHRC

1. **Massive Blasphemy-related Extrajudicial Killings:** The recent police killings of individuals accused of blasphemy highlight a troubling mix of state failure and mob justice, raising serious questions about due process as scrutinized by the UNHRC.
2. **Afghan Refugee Forced Returns:** The UN Human Rights Council has ramped up its focus on refugee rights, especially in light of the forced expulsion policies affecting around half a million Afghans.
3. **Digital Surveillance Crackdown:** Amnesty's recent findings about spyware highlight how Pakistan is using digital tools to silence dissent—raising serious concerns about online rights in the process.
4. **UPR Follow-Through via NCHR:** Pakistan's national human rights organization keeps a close eye on hundreds of UPR recommendations, actively working to implement them.
5. **Death Penalty via UPR Engagement:** Pakistan is leveraging the Universal Periodic Review (UPR) to tackle the issue of capital punishment and respond to international pressure—this has been emphasized as a crucial part of their legal reform strategy.
6. **Ethnic Minorities & Land Rights:** Instances where blasphemy is used against minorities to seize land highlight a troubling overlap of violations against both religious and property rights.
7. **Rule-by-Digital Coercion:** The rise of spyware and hacking for online silencing has introduced a fresh category for the UNHRC to review digital rights issues.

8. **Intensifying Political Space Constraints:** Reports about election manipulation and government crackdowns present Pakistan as a challenging scenario in the UNHRC's evaluations of democratic and civic freedoms.
 9. **Multi-Layered Refugee Crises:** Hosting Afghan refugees for the long haul, especially when their legal status is so precarious, really puts refugee rights front and center in the discussions at the Council.
 10. **UPR + ICCPR Dual Monitoring:** Pakistan's quick turnaround with the UPR and Universal Periodic Review under the ICCPR means it's getting a level of UN oversight that's pretty rare among its peers.
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